PEW RESEARCH CENTER
MAY 17-20, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,004

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
May 17-20, 2012	35	30	16	19	*
May 10-13, 2012	40	26	16	17	*
May 3-6, 2012	38	29	13	20	*
April 26-29, 2012	34	32	17	16	1
April 19-22, 2012	35	35	13	14	2
April 12-15, 2012	39	28	16	17	1
April 5-8, 2012	37	31	16	16	1
March 29-April 1, 2012	34	33	15	18	1
March 22-25, 2012	36	29	16	18	1
March 15-18, 2012	40	35	11	14	1
March 8-11, 2012	37	32	14	17	*
March 1-4, 2012	41	27	15	17	1
February 23-26, 2012	37	33	14	15	1
February 16-20, 2012	33	32	16	17	1
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. News about J.P. Morgan losing $2 billion or more in high-risk trading					
May 17-20, 2012	21	23	18	38	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
May 20-23, 2010: *Proposals for stricter regulation of banks and financial institutions*	22	29	21	28	1
April 30-May 3, 2010	19	28	19	33	1
April 23-26, 2012	27	26	20	27	*
June 19-22, 2009: *The Obama Administration's plans to expand regulations of financial institutions*	27	28	26	19	*
March 27-30, 2009: *The Obama Administration's plans to expand regulations over financial institutions*	36	29	19	16	*
c. News about Facebook's first public stock offering					
May 17-20, 2012	14	22	27	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
February 2-5, 2012: *Facebook announcing its plan for its first public stock offering*	7	17	25	50	1
d. Political and economic uncertainty in Greece					
May 17-20, 2012	15	22	22	41	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
May 10-13, 2012: *Reports about economic problems in several European countries*	17	24	24	34	*
May 3-6, 2012	16	23	24	36	*
February 16-20, 2012: *Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Europe*	11	21	23	45	*
January 12-15, 2012	12	23	23	42	1
December 8-11, 2011	14	22	27	37	1
December 1-4, 2011	14	24	25	36	1
November 10-13, 2011: *Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Greece and Italy*	15	23	23	38	1
November 3-6, 2011: *Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Greece and other European countries*	18	26	21	34	1
October 27-30, 2011	12	27	24	36	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September 29-October 2, 2011: *The debt crisis in Greece and other European countries*	15	21	24	39	1
September 15-18, 2011	16	23	24	37	1
August 18-21, 2011: *The debate among European leaders on how to address the region's debt crisis*	12	21	22	44	1
August 11-14, 2011: *Riots in London and other parts of* Britain	17	28	21	32	1
June 30-July 3, 2011: *The financial crisis and violent protests in Greece*	14	22	23	39	1
June 16-19, 2011	10	20	25	45	1
May 13-16, 2010: *A trillion-dollar bailout package for European governments facing debt problems*	21	26	24	28	2
May 7-10, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece and violent protests there*	19	23	26	31	*
April 30-May 3, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece*	6	15	28	51	1
October, 1998: *Financial instability around the world*	32	40	19	9	*
September, 1998: *Economic and political instability in Russia*	18	30	28	24	*
Late August, 1998: *Economic problems in Russia*	8	22	29	41	*
January, 1998: *The deepening financial crisis in many Asian countries*	15	25	27	33	*
March, 1995: *The financial and political instability in Mexico*	12	28	30	29	1
e. A U.S. Census report showing that minorities make up more than half of the babies born in the U.S.					
May 17-20, 2012	15	22	22	40	1
f. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election					
May 17-20, 2012	31	26	19	23	*
May 10-13, 2012	34	23	18	24	*
May 3-6, 2012	29	27	19	24	*
April 26-29, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
April 19-22, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
April 12-15, 2012	32	28	16	23	1
April 5-8, 2012	31	27	18	23	*
March 29-April 1, 2012	23	29	21	27	*
March 22-25, 2012	28	28	18	25	1
March 15-18, 2012	28	31	17	24	*
March 8-11, 2012	28	27	21	23	*
March 1-4, 2012	31	24	20	24	1
February 23-26, 2012	28	29	18	24	1
February 16-20, 2012	25	29	19	25	2
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? **[DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

May 17-20 2012	
28	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election
16	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
8	News about Facebook's first public stock offering
7	News about J.P. Morgan losing $2 billion or more in high risk trading
6	Political and economic uncertainty in Greece
4	A U.S. Census report showing that minorities make up more than half of the babies born in the U.S.
10	Some other story **(VOL.)**
21	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 Thinking about recent news coverage of some people, would you say the press has been too easy, too tough or fair in the way it has covered **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**?

	Too easy	Too tough	Fair	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Barack Obama				
May 17-20, 2012	28	19	41	13
November 3-6, 2011	26	22	41	11
July 21-24, 2011	27	23	41	9
November 18-21, 2010[1]	23	21	46	9
September 9-12, 2010	27	23	37	13
July 15-18, 2010	27	24	39	10
April 9-12, 2010	29	21	42	8
October 3-6, 2008	31	7	60	2
April 25-28, 2008	26	17	52	5
March 20-24, 2008	23	15	55	7
February 29-March 3, 2008	28	8	58	6
February 1-4, 2008	23	8	61	8
b. Mitt Romney				
May 17-20, 2012	21	15	47	18
February 2-5, 2012	19	14	47	19
November 3-6, 2011	12	9	53	26
July 21-24, 2011	16	9	45	30

[1] For November 18-21, 2010 this question was not asked in a list. For all other trends, this was a list item.